

Sunday, September 4

We were up early again. Matthew is teething. We prepared to be at the 9:30 service. Until then we enjoyed ourselves. Cheryl and I even sat down with a cup of coffee.

The weather was wonderful, pale blue sky, deep green in the grass and trees, a filtered sunlight. When the service ended we drove downtown for a light breakfast at the Sheraton. Matthew fell asleep on the way so we turned homeward. Cheryl slept too. Peter and I had toast. I read *Dune Messiah* and watched part of the game between the Broncos and Steelers. Peter was flying his Lego space jet in the hallway and rooms. We planned to ride our bikes to Mom and Dad's. First we cleaned the house, then changed Matthew's room around a bit. He seemed unhappy so we gave up the biking idea and drove. Mom and Dad weren't home. We went to the weir and walked along the riverbank.

We love the fall season. The wind is gentle. The sun is less hot but just as bright. The trail was crowded with strollers and bikers. A family carried a radio broadcasting the Rider-Bombers game. Pelicans swim right up to the falling water. Peter didn't want to walk at first, but he became interested in other things and stopped complaining. Cheryl and I talked about how good things were.

We went to the 21st Street Dairy Queen for hamburgers and ate them on a bench at Kiwanis Park. Matthew carried his bun on the lawn. A boy was lying flat on a super-light speedboat that made the sounds of a distant motor on a lake. Peter finished his hot dog and ran up and down the bank. Cheryl and I watched the river.

We stopped at a couple of stores on the way home. Tom Swingley saw me and talked for a few minutes before going into the Burger King. At home Peter and I read *The Hobbit*. Then Peter watched Walt Disney. I practised guitar. Cheryl made a few last minute preparations.

David and Lynette Dick arrived after 7. The boys were up until 8:30. Matthew was teasing Peter, getting close, Peter telling him not to be a bad boy, Matthew grabbing Peter's hair, me clearing him away, Matthew getting at Peter from another angle and grabbing his hair.

Let's not pretend that Peter is innocent. Matthew was playing with a box in the hallway. As Peter walked past him, he kicked the box out of Matthew's hands. As Matthew walked by Peter, who was sitting watching TV, a foot came out and tripped him. I think we're going to enjoy the next few years.

David and Lynette told us about their family and farms. We told them about our holiday. We discussed school and David's practise. The rain started at 10 and continued until morning. They ran to their BMW. We were reading in bed by 10:45. I slept shortly after. Cheryl lay awake until 2.

Matthew loves Peter's red baseball cap. He wears it sideways and over one ear. He views himself in a mirror. Cheryl watched him today. He stepped in front of Peter's mirror and said, "Hiiii".